

The Windswept Shores of Troy

The windswept shores of Troy stretch along a bright Aegean sea, where wooden ships with painted eyes lie beached on the long sand and a great city of honey-coloured walls stands proud on the hill above. For a long while two camps, the weary seafarers on the beach and the proud city behind its gates, have been caught in a tired old quarrel that neither truly wants. Across the wine-dark sea lies the long road home, full of wonders: a loyal old hound, a keeper of the winds, and lonely sea-singers on the rocks. Here a hero is not the strongest or the loudest, but the one who is clever, brave, and keeps faith with a friend. The grandest deeds are done not with spears but with a good idea and a kind heart, and the oldest quarrels often end with a single brave act of friendship.



Who's Who and What's What

Places

The Great Walls of Troy - The high, honey-coloured walls of the proud city on the hill, with great gates that have stayed shut through the long quarrel, and watchful but weary folk behind them.

The Isle of Winds - A floating island ringed with bronze cliffs where the keeper of the winds lives, and where a fair wind can be asked for with a clever and courteous word.

The Ship Camp - The seafarers' camp of tents and beached wooden ships along the long windswept beach, the heroes' home, with cook-fires and friendly faces and the sea always near.

The Weaving Hall - Home at last, across the sea: a warm hall where a great loom stands, a homecoming feast is laid, and old friends and a faithful hound are waiting.

The Wine-Dark Sea - The wide, deep sea that lies between the shores of Troy and home, beautiful and changeable, the great road of the long voyage back.

Characters

Aeolus, Keeper of the Winds - The gentle keeper of the winds on his floating isle, who lends a fair wind to travellers who ask cleverly and kindly, and never out of greed.



Odysseus the Clever - The famously clever captain of the seafarers, who prizes a good idea over a strong arm and sends the heroes out with a clever plan and a kind word.

Thetis the Sea-Mother - A gentle sea goddess who calms the waves and smiles on heroes that win by thinking and caring rather than by force.

Creatures

Argos the Faithful Hound - A loyal old dog who never forgets a friend or a scent, and who helps the heroes track down what is lost along the shore. Loyalty itself, with a wagging tail.

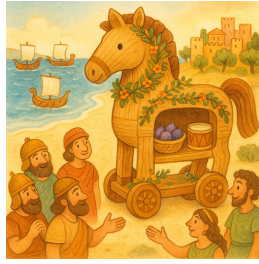
The Singing Sirens - Sea-singers on a rocky isle whose song is beautiful but sad and lonely. They are not wicked, only longing for company, and once cheered and befriended they sing travellers safely on their way.

Items

Penelope's Thread - A ball of strong weaving thread. Tie one end where you start and you can always find your way back, and it is handy for measuring and lashing besides.

The Basket of Honey and Figs - A basket of sweet honey and ripe figs. Shared with a wary stranger or a lonely singer, it can turn a frown into a friend.

The Conch Horn - A great spiral seashell that sounds a warm, calling note. Its sound carries a friendly message across the water and can soothe a troubled or lonely heart.



The Great Wooden Horse - A huge wooden horse on wheels that the heroes build. Filled not with soldiers but with gifts, music, and a hand of friendship, it can surprise a proud city into peace.

Words to Know

Cleverness - Quick thinking and a clever plan. On these shores, a good idea ends a quarrel that a thousand spears never could.

Courage - A steady heart on a wide and stormy sea. Courage is not being unafraid; it is being kind and clever even when you are afraid.

Loyalty - Standing by your friends and leaving no one behind. The greatest heroes of the shores are the ones who keep faith, help, and find their way home together.

Idea Bank: The Windswept Shores of Troy

Improv prompts for the grown-up. When the children want to try something the page did not plan for, reach in here. Nothing is a wrong answer; every idea bends toward cleverness, friendship, and nobody losing.

If the heroes are stuck

- Odysseus the Clever wanders past, rubs his beard, and asks a question that is really a hint in disguise.
- Argos the Faithful Hound trots up, sniffs, and points his nose the right way.
- A gull wheels overhead and drops a feather on the thing that matters.
- Let the heroes spend an energy star to "remember a trick an old sailor taught them".

Friendly faces to drop in

- A weary city guard who would rather share a fig than keep a gate shut.
- A dolphin who will show the safe channel for a kind word.
- A child on the walls who waves, curious, and could become a friend.
- An old shipwright who knows just how to make the timbers balance.

Gentle troubles to solve

- A heavy thing to move that only works if everyone lifts together.
- A row of ships to count, or planks to measure with Penelope's thread.
- A sad song across the water that asks to be answered, not fled.
- A gate that opens not to a push but to a gift and a friendly word.

Ways to win that are not winning

- End the quarrel with a surprise of friendship instead of a show of strength.
- Trade a basket of figs for a story rather than for the way through.
- Sing back to the lonely sirens until their song turns glad.
- Leave every shore kinder and every friend closer than you found them.

Aegean flavour to sprinkle

- Salt wind and the creak of timber, painted eyes on the prows, white sails snapping.
- Honey-coloured walls in the sun, olive trees, the smell of figs and cook-fires.
- The wine-dark sea at dawn, a faithful dog on the sand, a conch horn far off.

Stories in this world

Argos and the Lost Keepsake (young). The ships are nearly ready to sail home across the sea.

The Great Wooden Horse (young). For a long, long time the two camps on the windswept shores of Troy have been cross with each other.

The Long Way Home (older). The long quarrel is over, and it ended not with spears but with friendship.

Wits and Wonder

World Book

<https://github.com/agigante80/wits-and-wonder>

Content licence: CC BY-SA 4.0 (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0/>)

Version 2.4, updated 2026-06-04, en-GB



Scan for the latest version

Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.